SERVICE PROPOSAL

User Guide & Studio Manual

Prepared exclusively for Swift Reel Studio

> *Welcome to Swift Reel Studio! Think of this guide as your personal masterclass. Whether you are an experienced video editor or creating your very first short-form video, this handbook walks you through every single tool, shortcut, and creative technique step-by-step.*

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1. THE STUDIO INTERFACE AT A GLANCE

When you launch Reel Pipeline, you enter a dark-themed, DaVinci Resolve-inspired digital editing suite divided into four purpose-built zones:

!Studio Overview

- Top Control Bar: Project title, Undo/Redo buttons, quick job presets, and project save/open controls.
- Left Panel (Media Bin & AI Controls): Where you drop your reference video, select your raw camera footage folder, adjust cut-detection sensitivity, and trigger AI content tagging.
- Center Stage (Live Preview Monitor): Dual-deck 9:16 vertical playback monitor with interactive click-and-drag reframing, real-time white balance filters, and text overlays.
- Right Inspector Panel: Detailed per-clip controls for framing, pan & zoom, white balance, tonality curves, 3D LUTs, vignettes, fades, and text styling.
- Bottom Dock (Multi-Track Timeline): DaVinci Resolve-style continuous multi-track timeline

featuring a Timecode Ruler (TC), Text Track (T1), Video Track (V1), Audio Track (A1), and interactive 60 FPS playhead (CTI).

2. THE 3-STEP BEAT-SYNC REEL WORKFLOW

Creating a viral, fast-cut, rhythm-matched reel takes under 3 minutes:

> *[Step 1: Ingest Reference] [Step 2: Smart-Match Content] [Step 3: Build & Refine]*

Step 1: Analyze Your Reference Video

- Find any high-performing Instagram Reel, TikTok, or YouTube Short whose pacing and rhythm you admire.
- In the Step 1: Reference Reel box on the left, click Choose Video File and select your reference MP4 or MOV.
- Keep the Cut Sensitivity slider at the default 27.0 (or raise it if you want only hard cuts detected).
- Click Analyze Rhythm.
- What happens: PySceneDetect scans the video frame-by-frame, finds every cut point, and builds an exact rhythm map showing the duration of every single beat.

Step 2: Select Your Footage & Smart-Match

- In Step 2: Raw Footage, click Select Local Folder and pick the folder on your Mac SSD where your raw footage lives.
- (Optional AI Power) Check Smart-Match by Content (CLIP AI).
- Type category keywords that match your video (e.g. food, kitchen, cocktail, exterior, person).
- Click Tag Content.
- What happens: OpenAI CLIP analyzes your footage and matches your shots to the rhythm map by visual subject matter rather than random alphabetical order!

Step 3: Build the Reel

- Click Build Reel.
- Within seconds, your reel is compiled, color-graded, reframed to 9:16 vertical, and loaded directly onto the interactive timeline for fine-tuning.

3. MASTERING THE MULTI-TRACK TIMELINE

The timeline is designed to feel just like DaVinci Resolve and Adobe Premiere Pro:

!Multi-Track Timeline

Linear Timecode & Playhead (CTI)

- Every second on the timeline is mathematically locked 1:1 to the playback monitor (120 px/sec).
- Drag the cyan playhead (CTI) or click anywhere on the TC Ruler to scrub through your edit in real time at butter-smooth 60 FPS.

Trimming Clip In-Points and Out-Points (`[ ]`)

- Hover your mouse over the left edge of any video card to reveal the [handle. Drag it left or right to change where the clip starts.
- Hover over the right edge to reveal the] handle. Drag it left or right to lengthen or shorten the clip.
- Auto-Scroll Runway: There is a generous 650px blank runway past the end of the timeline. If you drag the last clip toward the edge of your screen, the timeline automatically scrolls horizontally with you!

Magnetic Snapping Tool (``)

- Toggle Snapping: Click the Magnet [ON] button on the timeline toolbar, or tap the <kbd>N</kbd> key on your keyboard (the universal Premiere Pro / DaVinci Resolve snapping shortcut).
- Cyan Magnetic Guide Line: When dragging clip trim handles, sliding text titles, or scrubbing the CTI playhead near a cut or layer boundary, an illuminated vertical cyan guide line (#38BDF8) snaps across all timeline tracks, locking your edit to the exact sub-frame.
- Magnetic Snap Targets:
- Video Cut Boundaries: Snap text titles and playhead directly to shot transitions.
- Playhead (CTI) Position: Park the playhead on an audio beat or spoken cue, then drag a clip's trim edge to snap right to the playhead!
- Text Track Boundaries: Snap adjacent titles together without awkward gaps or text overlaps.
- Custom Audio Start/End: Snap video cuts and text layers precisely to musical drops or track starts.
- Sequence Start (0.00s): Easily align initial layers to the very first frame.
- Freeform Mode: Tap <kbd>N</kbd> or click the magnet button to turn it into Magnet [OFF] whenever you want unrestricted, sub-pixel dragging without magnetic pull.

Reversing Clips (``)

- Click any clip on the V1 track, then click Reverse on the toolbar (or press <kbd>R</kbd>).
- The clip will instantly show a REV badge and play backwards in full original 4K/1080p resolution in the monitor!
- Non-destructive: Your original camera file is never touched or overwritten.

Deleting Layers & Clips (``)

The timeline features a smart, context-aware delete tool:

- To delete a Text Layer: Click the text title on the T1 track, then click Delete Text (or press <kbd>Delete</kbd> / <kbd>Backspace</kbd>).
- To delete a Video Shot: Click the video card on the V1 track, then click Delete Shot (or press <kbd>Delete</kbd> / <kbd>Backspace</kbd>).
- To clear the Custom Audio Track: Click the A1 audio track, then click Clear Audio (or press <kbd>Delete</kbd> / <kbd>Backspace</kbd>).
- Made a mistake? Press <kbd>Z</kbd> anytime to undo up to 10 steps back!

4. COLOR GRADING, 3D LUTS & REFRAME

Click any clip on the timeline and explore the Inspector Panel on the right:

!Inspector Panel

!Color Grading Pane

Spatial Reframe (Pan & Zoom)

- Drag the Zoom slider to crop into the action (100% to 300%).
- In the live preview monitor, click and drag the video with your mouse to reposition the framing horizontally or vertically!
- Scroll your mouse wheel directly over the video to zoom in and out.
- Click Apply Reframe to All Shots if you want your framing style applied across the entire video.

DaVinci Resolve-Style White Balance

- Temperature Slider: Slide right for warm, rich golden amber tones; slide left for cool, cinematic blue tones.
- Tint Slider: Balance magenta and green tones with true photographic accuracy.

- Uses an exact mathematical RGB matrix that avoids the fake green/purple wash of generic web filters.

Curves, Tonality & 3D LUTs

- Tonality Curves: Choose between Standard Linear, Punchy S-Curve (Rich Contrast), Filmic Muted Roll-Off, or High-Key Clean Pop.
- Vignette: Add natural optical lens falloff to draw the viewer's eyes directly to the center of the dish or subject.
- Fades: Add smooth fade-from-black or fade-to-black transitions in tenths of a second.
- 3D LUT Support: Click Load .CUBE LUT to apply your favorite DaVinci Resolve or camera manufacturer color grading LUTs (.cube).

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5. TEXT TITLES & TYPOGRAPHY (T1 TRACK)

Add stylish, modern captions and title cards that elevate your video:

- Add Text: Double-click any empty space on the purple T1 · TEXT track, or click + Add Text Item in the inspector.
- Position & Trim: Drag the text card along the timeline to choose when it appears. Drag its [and] handles to set how long it stays on screen.
- Interactive On-Screen Drag: In the live monitor, click and drag the text title directly to position it anywhere on screen!
- Custom Fonts: Click Upload Font (.ttf / .otf) to import your brand's official typography.
- Background Styles: Choose between clean transparent text, blurred frosted glass, semi-black badges, or glowing drop shadows.

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6. CUSTOM AUDIO & MUSIC SYNC (A1 TRACK)

By default, the app synchronizes your raw clips to the reference video's audio track. To add your own track:

- Click + Add Audio Track on the timeline toolbar and select any MP3, WAV, or M4A file.
- The A1 · AUDIO track lights up with a green waveform.
- Adjust Timing: Drag the left handle [to offset where the music starts. Drag the right handle] to trim its duration.

- Volume Control: Use the volume slider on the track header to mix background music between 0% and 150%.
- Original Audio: Check Keep Original Clip Audio if you want background kitchen sizzles, speech, or natural ambient sound layered underneath the music.

7. EXPORTING FOR SOCIAL MEDIA & DAVINCI RESOLVE

When your edit is ready, click Export Selected Formats on the left panel:

1. Direct Social Media Presets

- Instagram Reels & Stories: 1080×1920 @ 30 FPS, optimized for Instagram's compression engine.
- TikTok Master: 1080×1920 with high-bitrate audio and fast metadata start.
- YouTube Shorts (4K Master): 2160×3840 vertical 4K master file with pristine bitrate.

2. Industry Handoff (DaVinci Resolve & Premiere Pro)

Never get trapped in an AI app! Reel Pipeline gives you full NLE project handoff:

- Download FCPXML (v1.9): In DaVinci Resolve, go to File Import Timeline and select the .fcpxml. Resolve instantly recreates your exact timeline, linking each cut directly to your original 4K/6K camera files on disk!
- Download EDL (CMX 3600): Industry-standard Edit Decision List with accurate SMPTE timecodes.

8. AI SPEECH & SILENCE CLEANER

Need to turn a raw interview, talking-head video, or podcast into a punchy clip? Switch to the Speech Cleaner tab:

!Speech Cleaner

- Drop your raw spoken video file into the box.
- Click Clean Speech & Cut Dead Air.
- What the AI does: OpenAI Whisper listens to the audio, transcribes every word with millisecond precision, and identifies all pauses longer than 0.45 seconds as well as filler words ("um", "uh", "er").

- It cleanly slices out the dead air and joins the speech segments together seamlessly without changing audio pitch.

9. AI MEDIA SORTER

Have a camera card with 50+ mixed clips? Switch to the Media Sorter tab:

!AI Media Sorter

- Select your messy folder of video files.
- Type the categories you want (e.g. Cocktails, Food Dishes, Chef Action, Interior Dining).
- Click Sort Media with AI.
- OpenAI CLIP inspects every video and automatically sorts them into organized subfolders on your Mac, ready for your next project.

10. KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS CHEAT SHEET

Shortcut	Action	Description
<kbd>Spacebar</kbd>	Play / Pause	Toggles sequence playback or active monitor preview
<kbd>N</kbd>	Magnet / Snapping	Toggles magnetic snapping on/off across all timeline tracks
<kbd>R</kbd>	Reverse Clip	Toggles reverse playback for the selected video shot
<kbd>Delete</kbd> / <kbd>Backspace</kbd>	Delete Layer	Deletes the active text title, video shot, or audio track
<kbd>Z</kbd>	Undo	Reverts the last action (up to 10 steps back)

<kbd>Z</kbd> <kbd>Y</kbd>	/	Redo	Redoes the previously undone action
<kbd>C</kbd>		Copy Color Grade	Copies the color grade of the selected clip
<kbd>V</kbd>		Paste Color Grade	Pastes the color grade onto another selected clip
<kbd>S</kbd>		Save Project	Saves the current edit as a .reelproj bundle
<kbd>O</kbd>		Open Project	Opens an existing .reelproj bundle
<kbd>B</kbd>		Build Reel	Bakes all edits and renders the timeline
<kbd></kbd> <kbd></kbd>	/	Reorder Shots	Shifts the selected shot earlier or later in the edit
<kbd>1</kbd>		Beat Sync Tab	Switches to the main Beat Sync Studio
<kbd>2</kbd>		Cleaner Tab	Switches to the AI Speech Cleaner
<kbd>3</kbd>		Sorter Tab	Switches to the AI Media Sorter

11. PRO TIPS & SECRET SHORTCUTS

- Copy & Paste Color Across Clips: Grade one shot perfectly, press <kbd>C</kbd>, click any other shot on the timeline, and press <kbd>V</kbd> to copy the exact grade instantly.
- Smooth Reframe Scrolling: Place your cursor over the preview monitor and scroll up/down with your trackpad or mouse wheel to adjust zoom in real-time.
- Preserving 4K Camera Masters: Use the FCPXML export feature to take the AI's edit straight into DaVinci Resolve for final Dolby Vision or HDR grading.
- Zero-Lag Scrubbing: Click and drag directly on the Timecode Ruler (TC) above the video track to scrub at 60 FPS through cuts like a professional editor.

Happy editing with Swift Reel Studio!